

Book	Administrative Guideline Manual
Section	Administrative Guideline Updates
Title	Copy of RECESS GUIDELINE FOR HARSH WEATHER
Code	ag5360
Status	Up for Revision
Adopted	July 1, 2008

5360 - **RECESS GUIDELINE FOR HARSH WEATHER**

The administration is to establish the criteria (weather conditions) for determining, on a day-by-day basis, when recess will be held. The decision may vary from building to building.

Conditions that may be considered are:

- A. temperature (+20F°);
- B. wind chill;
- C. humidity;
- D. grade level/building;
- E. condition of the playground.

Exercise outdoors is healthy and is strongly encouraged. If conditions preclude the full recess time, even a five (5) minute break can revitalize children and prepare them for more sitting and academic learning.

The District's recess guidelines should be placed in the student/parent handbook and/or included in parent orientation meetings. All staff members who have recess duty need to be familiar with the recess guidelines.

IMPORTANT - Children with special health conditions, in particular, asthmatic children, may need special accommodation of their needs during cold weather or periods of high pollen or inversion. The parents of these children are to be consulted in creating a workable system for determining when other arrangements are necessary and for the child's supervision.

Hot Weather Guidelines:

- A. Provide for frequent water breaks or have plastic water bottles easily accessible.
- B. Watch carefully for possible heat exhaustion or over-exertion.
- C. Plan for less vigorous physical activity after mid-day.

Heat Index

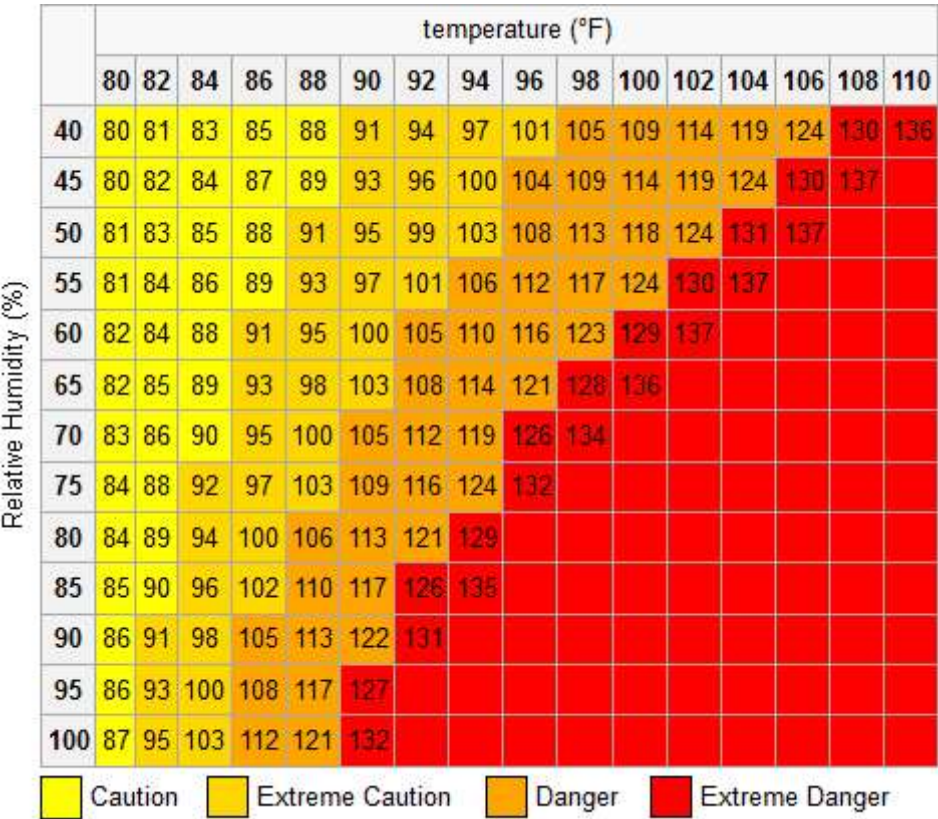
Heat index is often referred to as humiture, and is similar to wind chill in its attempt to measure the perceived rather than the actual temperature. For example, an air temperature of 83°F with a relative humidity of 70% would result in an estimated 88°F perceived temperature. This difference in perceived and actual temperature is the result of a mixture of air temperature, relative humidity, and wind speed.

The perception of heat is subjective, and can be affected by various factors such as menopause, pregnancy, and the effects of drugs or withdrawal, as well as differences in hydration, body shape, and metabolism. A higher relative humidity affects normal body cooling by reducing the rate of evaporation of sweat. The human body cools itself through

perspiration, where heat is removed from the body as a result of the evaporation of sweat. The lower rate of evaporation subsequently lowers the rate at which the body cools, increasing the perception of heat. This perception of heat is what the heat index seeks to measure, and while it can technically be used indoors, it is most often used in reference to the outside temperature.

Like the Wind Chill Temperature Index, the heat index used by the National Weather Service ("NWS") in the United States is based on many assumptions such as body mass, height, clothing, individual physical activity, blood thickness, and wind speed. As such, depending on how significantly these assumptions vary from the reality of an individual, heat index estimates may not accurately reflect the perceived temperature. The equation used by the NWS to estimate heat index was developed by George Winterling in 1978, and is meant to be valid for temperatures of 80°F or higher, and relative humidity of 40% or more. Below is a chart based on the NWS equation that can be used to estimate temperature and the level of danger associated with varying relative humidity percentages.

Heat Index Chart



Cold Weather Guidelines

WIND CHILL TEMPERATURES

How cold it feels on a winter day is a complex function of several factors, of which the most important are air temperature and wind speed. The wind moving past the skin during cold weather increases heat loss from the body. As the heat is lost, the body continues to pump new, warm blood to the outer extremities in an attempt to maintain the proper body temperature. If the air temperature is quite low and the wind strong, the body, in some cases cannot keep up with the heat loss and, therefore, the skin temperature decreases. The freezing of exposed portions of the body can result. However, the usual effect of the wind chill is plain old discomfort. Feeling colder than it really is, so to speak.

Following is a chart which gives the wind chill temperatures. For example, if the temperature is 25 degrees and the wind 20 mph, the wind chill temperature is -4 degrees. In other words, the above-mentioned condition of 25 degrees and a wind of 20 mph will have the same effect on the human body as no wind and a temperature of 4 degrees below zero.

It should be noted that water will not freeze until the actual air temperature is 32° F or less, regardless of what the wind chill temperature is.

WIND-CHILL CHART

Estimated Wind Speed	Actual Thermometer Reading °F.												
mph	50	40	30	20	10	0	-10	-20	-30	-40	-50	-60	
EQUIVALENT TEMPERATURE °F.													
Calm	50	40	30	20	10	0	-10	-20	-30	-40	-50	-60	
5	48	37	27	16	6	-5	-15	-26	-36	-47	-57	-68	
10	40	28	16	4	-9	-21	-33	-46	-58	-70	-83	-95	
15	36	22	9	-5	-18	-36	-45	-58	-72	-85	-99	-112	
20	32	18	4	-10	-25	-39	-53	-67	-82	-96	-110	-124	
25	30	16	0	-15	-29	-44	-59	-74	-88	-104	-118	-133	
30	28	13	-2	-18	-33	-48	-63	-79	-94	-109	-125	-140	
35	27	11	-4	-20	-35	-49	-67	-82	-98	-113	-129	-145	
40	26	10	-6	-21	-37	-53	-69	-85	-100	-116	-132	-148	
Wind speeds greater than 40 mph little additional effect	LITTLE DANGER FOR PROPERLY CLOTHED PERSON			INCREASING DANGER				GREAT DANGER					
				DANGER FROM				FREEZING OF EXPOSED FLESH					

To use the chart, find the estimated or actual wind speed in the left-hand column and the actual temperature in degrees F. in the top row. The equivalent temperature is found where these two intersect. For example, with a wind speed of 10 mph and a temperature of -10° F., the equivalent temperature is - 33° F. This lies within the zone of increasing danger of frostbite, and protective measures should be taken. (National Science Foundation, Washington D.C.)